Iranian Zoroastrianism, the Avesta, and its language, Early Iranian. There are also many cultural similarities which point to these two languages having a common source in Proto-Indo-Iranian.[17] Indeed, it was these close language affinities that led the eighteenth-century jurist and philologist Sir William 'Oriental' Jones to the revelation that the Sanskrit he had begun to study in Bengal in 1783 was not only born out of a shared Proto-Indo-Iranian parentage but was also part of a much wider and older language family with relatives extending far beyond Asia. That same link subsequently led the Indologist Max Müller to coin that now heavily loaded word 'Aryan', and to enthuse about 'our nearest intellectual relatives, the Aryans of India, the framers of the most wonderful language of Sanskrit, the fellow workers in the construction of our most fundamental concepts, the fathers of the most natural of natural religions'.

To understand the huge cultural gulf between the Harappans and the Arya you have only to consider what is and is not to be found in the *R-V*. Why, for example, does the *R-V* contain no reference to the unicorn-like creature that features so prominently in the Harappan seals, or to the rhinoceros, the elephant or the tiger? The early Arya had no words for them because they were unknown to them before they entered India.

Consider also the cow. The Arya's domesticated cattle were almost as much interlopers as they themselves, being of taurine stock (*Bos taurus taurus*) rather than the humped Indian zebu (*Bos indicus*), sometimes known as the Brahmini. These cattle were the Arya's lifeblood, glorified along with their horses as symbols of their moveable wealth and the basis of their sustenance. It followed that the most important of the Arya's rituals were the sacrifices of what was most precious to them: their horses and their cows. When the Sanskritist Horace Wilson, for many years Secretary of the Asiatic Society in Calcutta before leaving in